AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Workshop

Utilities & Swiss-Army Tools

49	656,332	82%	39
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

49 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-23** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

The swiss-army shelf: netcat-lineage utilities, intercept proxies, transport plumbing (Tor, socat), debuggers and format-inspectors. Unspecialized by definition — the tools you reach for when nothing specialized fits.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-23)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 33 of 40 tracked GitHub repos (82%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed):** none — 18-month-idle tools now move to the Legacy Vault
- **Earliest entries:** mitmproxy (2010), Netron (2010), Apktool (2012)

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 519 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
Ghidra	92.7k	2019	2026-10-20 ✓	Ghidra is a software reverse engineering (SRE) framework
ImHex	55.5k	2020	2026-10-09 ✓	A Hex Editor for Reverse Engineers, Programmers and people who value their retinas when working at 3 AM.
jadx	51.2k	2013	2026-10-14 ✓	Dex to Java decompiler
x64dbg	50k	2015	2026-10-20 ✓	An open-source user mode debugger for Windows. Optimized for reverse engineering and malware analysis.
mitmproxy	45.9k	2010	2026-10-22 ✓	An interactive TLS-capable intercepting HTTP proxy for penetration testers and software developers.
CyberChef	36.2k	2016	2026-10-19 ✓	The Cyber Swiss Army Knife - a web app for encryption, encoding, compression and data analysis

FULL INVENTORY — 49 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-23 census · non-GitHub tools listed without stars

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Ghidra	92.7k	2019	2026-10-20 ✓	— the NSA's open-source reverse-engineering suite; disassembly, decompilation and scripting for free. Used by reverse engineers analyzing binaries of any architecture; the NSA's free suite that stands in for IDA Pro and Binary Ninja.
ImHex	55.5k	2020	2026-10-09 ✓	— the hex editor with pattern language: parse formats while you view them. Used by reverse engineers parsing binaries with a pattern language; the free hex editor built for RE workflows. (GPL-2.0)

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
jadx	51.2k	2013	2026-10-14 ✓	— the standard Java/Android decompiler: dex-to-java source recovery with both GUI and CLI — the first stop for APK and JAR analysis. Used by Android reverse engineers decompiling DEX to readable Java; the free decompiler every APK analysis starts with. (Apache-2.0)
x64dbg	50k	2015	2026-10-20 ✓	— the open Windows debugger for x32/x64, with a plugin ecosystem built for RE. Used by malware analysts debugging Windows binaries; the free Windows debugger that stands in for commercial debuggers. (GPL-3.0)
mitmproxy	45.9k	2010	2026-10-22 ✓	— interactive HTTPS interception for debugging and testing your own apps; scriptable as a library. Used by developers and pentesters intercepting HTTPS traffic programmatically; the free alternative to Charles Proxy and Fiddler.
CyberChef	36.2k	2016	2026-10-19 ✓	— GCHQ's web Swiss-army knife: 400+ operations for decoding, transforming and analyzing data, all client-side. Used by analysts daily for decoding, crypto and data wrangling; GCHQ's free web tool that replaces a shelf of utilities.
Netron	33.6k	2010	2026-10-22 ✓	— visualize ML models: the layers, weights and graph of what you deploy. Used by ML engineers inspecting model architectures; the free visualizer for neural-network files. (MIT)
OpenSSL	31k	2013	2026-10-21 ✓	— the TLS library the internet runs on — and the CLI for keys, certs, CSRs and everything crypto. Used by literally everyone through the TLS it provides; the open library the commercial internet runs on.
Apktool	26.5k	2012	2026-10-17 ✓	— disassemble and rebuild Android APKs: decode resources to near-original form, patch smali, repackage and sign — the Android RE classic. Used by mobile pentesters decoding Android resources and smali; the standard free APK disassembler. (Apache-2.0)
radare2	25.1k	2012	2026-10-22 ✓	— the scriptable reverse-engineering framework: disassemble, debug, patch, anywhere. Used by reverse engineers scripting binary analysis; the free framework that powers many commercial RE pipelines. (LGPL-3.0)
Frida	22.4k	2013	2026-10-20 ✓	— inject JavaScript into running processes; dynamic instrumentation for mobile, desktop and IoT. Used by mobile pentesters and researchers injecting logic into running processes; the dynamic-instrumentation standard. (GPL-2.0 / wxWindows dual)
Ciphey	21.7k	2019	2026-10-13 ✓	— automated decoder: paste ciphertext, get plaintext plus the method used — evidence triage in seconds. Used by CTF players and analysts auto-decoding ciphertext; the free automated decoder.
Cutter	20.1k	2017	2026-09-11	— free and open reverse-engineering platform powered by rizin: graph disassembly, decompiler views and debugging in a polished desktop UI. Used by RE learners driving Ghidra through a friendlier GUI; the free reverse-engineering IDE. (GPL-3.0)
binwalk	14.5k	2013	2026-08-11	— firmware analysis: scan, extract and identify embedded files and filesystems. Used by firmware researchers extracting embedded filesystems and images; the standard free firmware-analysis tool. (MIT)
XERJ	13.1k	2026	2026-10-22 ✓	— local-first search engine and MCP server in a single Rust binary: hybrid BM25 + vector search over code, docs, logs and PDFs with an Elasticsearch-compatible API — for agents and humans alike. Used by security teams giving AI agents searchable, air-gapped memory over case files and codebases; the self-hosted retrieval layer for agent workflows. (Apache-2.0)
Scapy	12.6k	2015	2026-10-22 ✓	— packet crafting without limits: forge, sniff, dissect and send anything — the Python network Swiss-army knife. Used by network researchers crafting packets in Python; the standard library protocol testing builds on. (GPL-2.0)
Detect It Easy	11.8k	2014	2026-10-21 ✓	— packer/compiler/protection detection with a rule engine. Used by malware analysts identifying packers and compilers; the free packer-detection standard. (MIT)

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dnSpyEx	11.3k	2021	2026-10-17 ✓	— the .NET debugger and decompiler, continued; edit assemblies live. Used by .NET researchers decompiling and debugging managed code; the maintained fork of the classic .NET debugger. (GPL-3.0)
pwndbg	11.1k	2015	2026-10-21 ✓	— GDB with a exploit-dev UX: heap awareness, shortcuts and sane defaults. Used by CTF players and exploit developers making GDB pwn-friendly; the standard GDB plugin for exploitation work. (MIT)
Capstone	9.1k	2013	2026-10-21 ✓	— the disassembly framework behind countless security tools. Used by security developers embedding disassembly; the free engine behind countless RE and EDR tools. (BSD-3-Clause)
pyWhat	7.3k	2021	2026-10-13 ✓	— identify anything: hashes, keys, URLs, PII — the "what is this string?" answer. Used by analysts identifying arbitrary blobs and strings; the free 'what is this' identifier.
Faraday	6.8k	2013	2026-10-21 ✓	— the pentest collaboration platform: import tool output, deduplicate findings and manage the whole engagement. Used by pentest teams collaborating on findings; the community edition of the commercial collaboration platform. (GPL-3.0)
Dangerzone	5.8k	2020	2026-10-21 ✓	— takes hostile documents and re-renders them as safe PDFs inside an isolated sandbox. Used by newsrooms converting untrusted documents into safe PDFs; the free sanitization tool for adversarial files. (AGPL-3.0)
UEFITool	5.8k	2013	2026-07-29	— parse, extract and replace UEFI firmware images. Used by firmware analysts parsing UEFI images; the free tool for BIOS/UEFI research. (BSD-2-Clause)
ExifTool	5.2k	2018	2026-05-27	— the metadata reader/writer for files and images; the last word in metadata triage. Used by investigators reading and stripping file metadata; the standard free metadata tool used across forensics. (Perl Artistic/GPL)
DefectDojo	5k	2015	2026-10-22 ✓	— open-source vulnerability management and AppSec platform: import findings from your whole scanner fleet, deduplicate, track remediation and map to compliance from one self-hosted app. Used by security teams running continuous vulnerability management across scanners; the free alternative to commercial ASPM platforms. (BSD-3-Clause)
Kaitai Struct	4.7k	2016	2026-10-19 ✓	— declare a binary format once, generate parsers for nine languages. Used by protocol researchers declaring binary formats as YAML; the free declarative parser generator for format RE. (MIT)
Interactsh	4.6k	2021	2026-10-22 ✓	— out-of-band interaction server for detecting blind vulnerabilities (SSRF, blind RCE, blind XXE). Used by bug hunters detecting out-of-band interactions blind spots miss; ProjectDiscovery's free alternative to Burp Collaborator.
pwndoc	2.9k	2020	2026-10-02 ✓	— offline pentest report generator: reusable finding databases, CVSS scoring and multi-language docx templates that turn engagement notes into client-ready reports. Used by pentesters producing polished client reports without cloud tooling; the free offline reporting suite for engagements. (MIT)
ATT&CK Navigator	2.5k	2018	2026-10-20 ✓	— MITRE's matrix explorer: layer, annotate and score ATT&CK techniques for detection-coverage planning. Used by purple teams planning and visualizing coverage; the free MITRE tool for layer-based ATT&CK exploration.
boofuzz	2.4k	2015	2026-09-21	— network protocol fuzzing framework descended from Sulley — script your protocol and hardware bug hunts. Used by protocol fuzzers finding crashes in network services; the open-source fuzzing framework from the Sulley lineage. (GPL-2.0)
Brida	1.9k	2017	2025-10-30	— the bridge between Burp and Frida: custom instrumentation in your proxy workflow. Used by mobile pentesters bridging Frida into Burp; the free companion for SSL-pinning bypass work. (MIT)

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tcpreplay	1.4k	2013	2026-08-15	— replay captured traffic at arbitrary speed for testing and validation. Used by engineers replaying captures at original speed; the free pcap replay tool for testing sensors. (GPL-3.0)
GnuPG	991	2015	2026-10-21 ✓	— the free implementation of OpenPGP: encrypt, sign and verify files and mail, everywhere. Used by privacy-conscious users for email and file encryption; the free open implementation of OpenPGP. (GPL-3.0)
OCSF	906	2022	2026-10-21 ✓	— the Open Cybersecurity Schema Framework: one schema for security events. Used by SIEM and security vendors normalizing telemetry; the open schema standard the industry is converging on. (Apache-2.0)
Dradis CE	843	2016	2026-10-21 ✓	— collaborative pentest reporting: team notes, evidence and findings assembled into one professional report. Used by pentest teams assembling reports from tool output; the free edition of the commercial reporting platform. (GPL-2.0)
Hachoir	671	2016	2026-10-14 ✓	— binary field inspection: split any file into its fields, even damaged ones. Used by researchers extracting metadata from damaged binaries; the free Python metadata extractor. (GPL-2.0)
Vulnrepo	583	2017	2026-10-07 ✓	— free end-to-end-encrypted vulnerability report generator and repository: CWE/CVE/MITRE templates, scanner imports, DOCX output and Jira export. Used by pentesters assembling reports fast after engagements; the free alternative to commercial reporting suites. (Apache-2.0)
friTap	561	2021	2026-09-29 ✓	— intercept TLS keys in real time for analysis; a Frida script for the lab. Used by traffic analysts extracting TLS keys from apps via Frida; the free tool for decrypting stubborn mobile traffic. (GPL-3.0)
cybersec-toolkit	77	2026	2026-10-21 ✓	— single-command installer for 670+ security tools with an authorization-gated MCP server, allowlist and flag-denylist execution policy and a prompt-injection output sanitizer. Used by security engineers building safe tool environments for AI agents; the least-privilege installer for agent-accessible security tooling. (MIT)
angr	—	—	—	— the binary-analysis platform from UCSB's Shellphish: symbolic execution at scale. Used by researchers and CTF players symbolically executing binaries; the free platform for program analysis research. (BSD-2-Clause)
Evan's Debugger	—	—	—	— the C/C++ debugger with a RE focus: memory views built for analysis. Used by RE practitioners debugging Linux binaries in a GUI; the free Qt-based debugger. (GPL-2.0+)
Hex Fiend	—	—	—	— the fast, open-source hex editor for macOS. Used by macOS researchers editing binaries fast. (BSD-2-Clause)
I2P	—	—	—	— the Invisible Internet Project: anonymous, self-organizing overlay network. Used by privacy-focused users running encrypted overlay networking; the free Invisible Internet Project with no commercial counterpart. (multiple open licenses)
netcat	—	—	—	— the original TCP/IP Swiss army knife: reads and writes across networks with one command. Used by everyone from sysadmins to CTF players for raw TCP/UDP plumbing. (freeware)
socat	—	—	—	— the relay for bidirectional data transfer between addresses: TCP, UDP, sockets, pipes. Used by sysadmins and pentesters relaying and shaping network connections; the netcat successor for serious plumbing. (GPL-2.0)
Tails	—	—	—	— the amnesic incognito live system: no trace left on the machine. Used by journalists needing amnesic, compartmentalized computing; the free live system that leaves no trace. (GPL-3.0)
tcpdump	—	—	—	— the command-line packet capture classic; quick looks and long captures where Wireshark won't fit. Used by admins capturing packets on servers without GUIs; the classic free CLI sniffer preinstalled everywhere.

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Wireshark	—	—	—	— the packet analyzer everyone knows; deep protocol visibility for troubleshooting and forensics. Used by network engineers and DFIR analysts everywhere; the standard free packet analyzer commercial tools still get compared to. (GPL-2.0)